

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT

POLICY MANUAL

VOLUME 6

Policy: 600.01 Firefighter Code of Ethics

11/2023

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I understand that I have the responsibility to conduct myself in a manner that reflects proper ethical behavior and integrity. In so doing, I will help foster a continuing positive public perception of the fire service. Therefore, I pledge the following...

- Always conduct myself, on and off duty, in a manner that reflects positively on my department, the fire service and myself in general.
- Accept responsibility for my actions and the consequences of my actions.
- Support the concept of fairness and the value of diverse thoughts and opinions.
- Avoid situations that would adversely affect the credibility or public perception of the fire service profession.
- Be truthful and honest at all times and report instances of cheating or other dishonest acts that compromise the integrity of the fire service.
- Conduct my personal affairs in a manner that does not improperly influence the performance of my duties, or bring discredit to my organization.
- Be respectful and conscious of each member's safety and welfare.
- Recognize that I serve in a position of public trust that requires stewardship in the honest and efficient use of publicly owned resources, including uniforms, facilities, vehicles and equipment and that these are protected from misuse and theft.
- Exercise professionalism, competence, respect and loyalty in the performance of my duties and use information, confidential or otherwise, gained by virtue of my position, only to benefit those I am entrusted to serve.
- Avoid financial investments, outside employment, outside business interests or activities that conflict with or are enhanced by my official position or have the potential to create the perception of impropriety.
- Never propose or accept personal rewards, special privileges, benefits, advancement, honors or gifts that may create a conflict of interest, or the appearance thereof.
- Never engage in activities involving alcohol or other substance use or abuse that can impair my mental state or the performance of my duties and compromise safety.
- Never discriminate on the basis of race, religion, color, creed, age, marital status, national origin, ancestry, gender, sexual preference, medical condition or handicap.

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- Never harass, intimidate or threaten fellow members of the service or the public and stop or report the actions of other firefighters who engage in such behaviors.
- Responsibly use social networking, electronic communications or other media technology opportunities in a manner that does not discredit, dishonor or embarrass my organization, the fire service and the public. I also understand that failure to resolve or report inappropriate use of this media equates to condoning this behavior

By signing this form, I acknowledge that I have received and understand the Calimesa Fire Department Code of Ethics

Print Name: _____

Sign Name: _____

Date: _____

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CODE OF CONDUCT

Members of the City of Calimesa Fire Department are required to maintain certain standards of conduct so that the functions of the Department are carried out in an efficient, fair, and impartial manner. Such standards of behavior ensure that Fire Department employees act with integrity and ethics that maintain the public trust. The Policy's, Rules and Regulations serve as the Calimesa Fire Department's Code of Conduct.

It is the responsibility of each individual to observe the letter and spirit of the Rules and Regulations in the performance of their duties and to remain vigilant to the code of conduct on and off duty. The primary responsibility of all members is to act in the public interest as expressed by the policies promulgated by the City of Calimesa, the City Council, and the Calimesa Fire Department. You are required to become familiar with your obligations and to comply with this code of conduct. It is expected that you will do everything you can to apply the principles to your decision-making.

While policies, Rules and Regulations, and State and Federal legislation are important, ultimately the decisions you make every day in the performance of your work may have wide-ranging economic, legal, and ethical implications. Making fair-minded decisions requires application of City work ethics including respect for the law, integrity, diligence, and respect for the dignity and human rights of all persons. You are expected to always act with these principles in mind. This is the responsibility of working at one of the finest professional fire departments in the world.

While this code of conduct specifies several rules and regulations which govern professional behavior, you are also expected to familiarize yourself with the other documents that support integrity, ethics, respect, and legal behavior. The following list informs you of other policies and work rules with which you are expected to comply:

1. Calimesa Municipal Code
2. Calimesa Personnel Rules and Regulations
3. All applicable MOU's
4. All Applicable Operating Agreements

Breaches of the code of conduct will be dealt with in accordance with the disciplinary system and guidelines. Enforcement and implementation of the disciplinary process addresses

personal and professional accountability and the reinforcement of ethical behavior. It is expected that in the course of their work every employee exercise self-discipline deserving of the respect and admiration of the citizens we serve and our fellow members.

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CHIEF'S EXPECTATIONS FOR DAILY OPERATIONS

- Prior to 07:00 hrs.: Wake Up, Showers, Breakfast
- Morning briefing **ALL** personnel oncoming or off-going are to be dressed in Class B Uniform, unless participating in supervised or approved on-duty department physical training.
- 07:00 -12:00: Flag Up, Morning Briefing, Reports, Vehicles and Equipment Checkouts, Training, Station Chores, Department Projects.
- *12:00 -13:00: Lunch
- 13:00-17:30: Continue with Vehicles and Equipment Checkouts, Training, Station Chores, Department Projects,
- Flag Down at Sunset,
- Company Officer to Ensure all assigned tasks by Management are completed.
- 17:30: Dinner, Personal Time, Company/Chief Officer Confirm Station Security prior to lights out.

* Lunch period may be adjusted based on incident call volumes, station chores, and department projects.

** Personal time may be adjusted based on incident call volume, urgency of station chores and urgency of Department projects.

*** All televisions/radios, electronic devices, lights, etc. to be turned off in unoccupied rooms.

**** Off-going Personnel shall not depart the facility prior to being released by Company/Duty Battalion Chief. Station facilities and apparatus shall be clean and ready for hand-off prior to shift change.

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i. PURPOSE

The Department responds to a wide range of emergency incidents. This directive identifies standard operating guidelines to be employed in establishing command. This allows for the effective management of personnel and resources providing for the safety and welfare of personnel. It establishes guidelines for the implementation of all components of the Incident Command System (ICS) for incident operations including:

- A. Fixing the responsibility for command on a specific individual through a standard system, depending on the arrival sequence of companies and chief officers.
- B. Establish an effective incident organization by defining the activities and responsibilities assigned to the Incident Commander and to other individuals operating within ICS.
- C. Provide a system to process information to support incident management, planning, and decision-making including command responsibility and modes of operations.

II. RESPONSIBILITY

All suppression personnel shall be completely familiar with the procedures outlined in this directive and be able to perform according to their position.

III. SCOPE

These procedures govern actions at all incidents requiring a command structure.

V. GENERAL PROCEDURES

The general procedures outline the operating principles that establish the framework for emergency incident operations and command. The effective functioning of units and personnel at incidents requires clear decisive action on the part of an Incident Commander.

- A. The Incident Commander (IC) is responsible for the completion of the tactical priorities. The main tactical priorities are:

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1. Remove endangered occupants and treat the injured.
2. Stabilize the incident and provide life safety.
3. Conserve property.
4. Continuously provide for the safety, accountability, and welfare of all personnel.

B. The Incident Commander is responsible for all functions of command including:

1. Assume and announce command and establish an effective operating position (Incident Command Post).
2. Rapidly evaluate the situation (size up).
3. Initiate, maintain, and control the communications process.
4. Identify a clear and concise strategy that is easily understood by all personnel.
5. Develop an Incident Action Plan (IAP) and assign companies and personnel consistent with plan and standard operating guidelines.
6. Develop an effective ICS organization.
7. Provide tactical objectives.
8. Review, evaluate, and revise the Incident Action Plan as needed.
9. Provide for the continuity, transfer, and termination of command.
10. Ensure required reports are completed.

c. The Incident Commander (IC) should begin to institute the Incident Command System (ICS) and appoint ICS positions whenever three (3) or more units are involved in an incident, or based on the following:

1. When the IC predicts the incident will involve a number of companies beyond the capability to directly control, or the IC cannot effectively

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manage the number of companies currently involved in the operation. In such cases, early recognition and delegation are essential.

2. When companies are operating from tactical positions over which the IC has little control or are involved in complex operations.

D. All subordinate ICS positions created by the IC shall be structured by the following guidelines:

1. The Incident Commander is responsible for building an ICS organization that matches the organizational needs of the incident to achieve the tactical priorities.
2. The number of companies assigned to an organizational position depends upon conditions within that assignment. Five companies represent the recommended maximum ICS span of control. The IC will maintain an awareness of the number of companies operating under an ICS position and the capability of the officer to effectively manage them.
3. ICS positions established at an incident shall be designated as outlined by FIREScope 420-1 and NIIMS. The most common positions are below however any needed position can be established:

a. STAGING AREA- Geographical name (Example - Sierra Staging)

b. BRANCHES

(i) Numerical (Example - Branch 1)

(ii) Functional (Example - Medical Branch)

c. DIVISIONS

(i) Alphabetical (Example - Division A)

(i)

(ii) Geographical (Example - Roof Division)

(iii) Numerical (Multi-story by floor) (Example - Division 9)

(iiii) When assigning a division, boundaries and responsibilities shall be identified.

d. GROUPS